

Enåkers slöjdskolans dagbok åren 1900-1902

A digitalisation project

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1. Introduction

To fulfill the requirements on the digitalisation for preservation and accessibility course on the Library and Information Science Masters Programme at Borås University, we were tasked with a group digitalisation project in partnership with a cultural heritage actor. The is to digitalise a chosen material with the view to preserve and increase its accessibility. We partnered with Enåker's local heritage association (Enåker's Local Heritage Association, 2026) that focuses on preserving the cultural heritage of Enåker parish in Heby, Uppsala.

The heritage association allowed us to choose the material we wished to digitise, and we made our selection based on the preservation needs of the material available in the Heby municipal archives, in combination with our own abilities and the course's guidelines. We considered what would be deemed the most interesting for the area's residents, many of whom have a long history to the area dating back several generations.

After a visit to the municipal archives accompanied by members of the heritage association, we selected a logbook from the village's carpentry school, dated 1900—1908. In addition to the pupils' attendance record, their residences and guardians are listed alongside the projects created. Information on starting and finishing dates for projects is largely provided as is the grade awarded to each. Occasionally, additional remarks feature, detailing immigration or emigration to the parish for example. The register is handwritten in a mixture of pen and pencil.

The logbook serves as a historical record of the families living in the area allowing interested parties to track residents and providing information on trades and industries as well as settlements and objects created that were deemed useful to a rural society.

The material is in an unconventional book format measuring 245 mm in width and 380 mm in length and having conventional pages sized 238 mm in width and 355 mm in length, as well as smaller pages measuring 113 mm in width and 355 mm in length. Between two conventional size paper sheets there are two smaller sized paper sheets, i.e. each full-size page of the book is accompanied by two smaller pages. This, according to the National Library of Sweden, classifies the book as folio (Sörensen, 2026). The logbook is in good condition, but the spine is at risk of damage and the paper has some staining.

2. Aim

The aim of this project was to explore and evaluate methods for digitising a structured historical record from the early 20th century, with focus on image capture, transcription, and metadata creation.

The project's aims were to understand: 1) which image capturing method would be most suitable to preserve a logbook, more specifically we were interested in knowing whether pictures of the logbook would be more suitable than scanning the material, and vice versa; 2) whether using Optical Character Recognition (OCR) would be appropriate to transcribe material that is handwritten in early 1900s calligraphy; 3) if the Text Encoding Initiative (TEI; The Text Encoding Initiative Consortium, 2026) format or HTML would be most appropriate to preserve the tabular nature of the logbook, and 4) whether metadata in TEI-would be sufficient to preserve the nature of the logbook.

3. Methods

3.1. Image capture and editing

To digitise the logbook, we used a Bookeye 5 bookscanner. The logbook was digitised in 24-bit colour, 400 DPI resolution and “anti-reflection” mode. All digitised images were stored in a single PDF file, version 1.7. The PDF producer is libimg Image Output V7.30E-rc8 © Image Access.

To separate the PDF file into separate images, we used Photoshop (Adobe Acrobat, 2026). We imported each page individually and saved it in psd format. We then edited the images in GIMP 3.2.4 (Kimball & Mattis, 2026).

In GIMP, we cropped images to visual noise, which was done using the clone tool and painting over the item to be removed with a nearby matching texture and colour. The images were exported to both jpeg and png formats with lower quality (80). We used the “show preview in image window”, “progressive”, “optimize” and subsampling to 4:2:0 (chrome quartered) settings. The jpeg format was chosen for size optimisation (Cornell University Library, 2003).

We added metadata to each image used through properties. We added the title, authors, date taken and copyright, to the metadata that was automatically generated.

3.2. Transcription

After uploading images to Google (Google, 2026) OCR, we determined it would be more accurate to manually transcribe the text, especially as the handwriting was largely legible.

All tables in the logbook were transcribed into a Google Sheets spreadsheet upon reading the book which we structured as close to the original as possible. The logbook's cover and first page were transcribed directly into TEI. A member of the heritage association proof-read the transcription and helped complete it where necessary.

3.3. Text encoding

To address whether TEI would be an appropriate approach towards preserving historical digitised logbooks, we first attempted preserving the transcribed text directly in HTML. For this, we encoded tables directly in HTML, though we quickly realised that using TEI would be the superior approach for preserving our material.

We used TEI to encode the logbook's transcription on the website. Our choice was based on how it facilitates the preservation of the material.

With TEI, preservation of text elements such as names and dates was relatively easy, as specific tags can be used for those. Moreover, TEI made it simple to preserve the table structure that exists in the original logbook.

We also chose TEI due to its ability to store the metadata.

The TEI file is in XML format. As a starting point, we used Wout Dillen's DCHM template (The Text Encoding Initiative Consortium, 2026). To code the TEI file, we used Oxygen XML Editor (Soft Syncro, 2026).

The file is structured using three modules: <teiHeader>, <facsimile>, and <text>. All project and logbook related metadata are stored under <teiHeader>. All images are described as separate <surface> elements under <facsimile>, and all transcribed text is stored under different <div> elements under <text>.

Each <surface> element was given a unique ID, which was used to link to the corresponding <div> under <text>. Each <surface> element has a <figure> element nested under it, and each <figure> is described with a <label> element, a <figDesc> element, and a <graphic> element, which is also assigned a unique ID.

To preserve the tabular nature of the logbook, the element <table> was used under <div>. An exception to this was the transcription of the logbook's cover and first page, which are not in tabular format.

3.4. Metadata

We chose to follow the PREMIS method and to store all the metadata in the TEI file. All metadata are stored under the element <teiHeader>.

Under <teiHeader> there are two nested elements <fileDesc>, which was used to store all project metadata, as well as information about the logbooks content and physical characteristics, and <profileDesc>, which was used to store information on the language of the logbook under and types of ink used.

The element <fileDesc> contains four nested elements: <titleStmt> that stores information on the title and project authors; <publicationStmt> that stores discovery metadata; <sourceDesc>, that stores metadata on the logbook itself, and <encodingDesc>, that stores information on how the text was transcribed and how and where the logbook was digitised.

The element <publicationStmt> encompasses the elements <publisher>, <date>, and <availability>. The latter includes a written statement on the licence, as well as the element <licence>.

Under <titleStmt> we used the field <title> to store the project's title, as well as the fields <author> and <principal> to store information on the project's authors and transcribers and their contact emails, respectively.

The most complex element under <teiHeader> is <sourceDesc>, which stores information on the logbook, its content, and its physical characteristics. We used the element <msDesc> to describe the manuscript. Under it, the elements <msIdentifier>, <msContents>, <additional> and <physDesc> are nested. The element <msIdentifier> contains the element <repository>, which describes where the physical logbook is stored. Under <msContents>, we give a description of the information stored in the logbook. The element <additional> was used to provide information on the scope of the digitalisation project. To describe the unique physical features of the logbook, we used the elements <objectDesc> under <physDesc>. The element <objectDesc> encompasses two elements: <supportDesc> and <layoutDesc>. In TEI, the <supportDesc> element is used to provide information on the physical support of a material's content. We used a <dimensions> element nested under <supportDesc>, with <width> and <height> elements nested under it to preserve information on the logbook's size. The element <layoutDesc> was used to preserve information on the logbook's special layout, with full size and small size pages. Two <layout> elements were used, corresponding to each page type. We used a <dimensions> element nested under each <layoutDesc>, with <width> and <height> elements nested under it.

The element <encodingDesc> has two elements nested under it: <editorialDecl>, that describes how the logbook was transcribed under <information>, and <samplingDecl>, that describes where the logbook was digitised and which equipment was used to do it.

3.5. Webpage

The webpage is coded in HTML and published via GitHub pages.

The webpage is entirely written in Swedish with has six subpages: “hem” (home), “transkription” (transcription), “dagbok” (logbook), “galleri” (gallery), “projekt” (project), and “resurser” (resources).

The HTML files for “hem”, “transkription”, “dagbok”, and “galleri” were generated from XSL files that used TEI as a source for key elements including images and transcription. We used the DCHM template (Dillen, 2026) as a guiding post for our XSL code. Since we customised the TEI file with tables, we also customised the XSL files with specific templates for the table, row, and cell elements in TEI. The XSL file for “galleri” was not taken from the DCHM template (Dillen, 2026) but the template served as inspiration.

We used Oxygen XML Editor to run the XSL code and generate the HTML files.

We decided to show one image only in the “hem” subpage instead of the image carousel coded in the template. Because of this, we changed the HTML code behind “hem” after using XSL to generate the HTML file, as we could not find a way to call just one TEI ID in the XSL file.

The “projekt” and “resurser” HTML files were coded directly in HTML (i.e., we did not use XSL to generate these files), as we did not use any TEI-elements in these.

To style the website, we used a .css stylesheet which was heavily based on the DCHM (Ho, 2026) template and customised by us.

All handling of HTML and .css was done in Notepad++ (Ho, 2026).

3.6. Publication

The website is published on GitHub. We created a GitHub project to host our website and project related files. Both group members are contributors (Berghwall & Ribeiro, 2026) .

The GitHub project is based on the DCHM template (Dillen, 2026) and it is organised in three main folders: “collection”, “docs” and “report”.

The folder “collection” is divided into two subfolders “tei” and “transcription”. Under “tei” we store the TEI file that encodes the project’s metadata, as well as the XML transcription. The spreadsheet containing the entire transcription is stored under

“transcription”. Originally, we planned to store the raw scanned file under “collection”, but due to its large size, Google Drive was better suited.

The folder “docs” is where all website files and objects are stored, and it has a subfolder “assets”. All html files used on the website are stored directly under “docs”. Under “assets” there are three subfolders: “img”, “css” and “xsl”. To store images created for the website, as well as the relevant logos, we use the folder “img”. The folder “img” is therefore divided into two subfolders: “docs” and “logos”, with all images being stored in the former, and all logos being stored in the latter. The folder “docs” has all images currently used on the website stored directly under it, while the images that are not currently used on the website, but that we plan to use in a future iteration, are stored under the subfolder “Not used”. The stylesheet used across the website is stored under “css”, and the XSL files used to generate the HTML from TEI are stored under “xsl”.

The folder “report” contains the project’s report.

4. Time estimation

Table 1. Estimation of the time used on the project by task

<i>Task</i>	<i>Hours spent</i>	<i>Comments</i>
<i>Group meetings and communication</i>	65	
<i>Meetings and communication with the local heritage association, and archive visits</i>	30	
<i>Digitalization (Image scanning)</i>	5	
<i>Image editing</i>	30	Task originally planned for 2
<i>Transcription</i>	110	Task originally planned for 2
<i>GitHub (creating, structuring, synching, publishing pages)</i>	30	
<i>Text encoding (XML)</i>	130	Task originally planned for 2
<i>Webpage (XSL and HTML)</i>	60	
<i>Report</i>	60	Task originally planned for 4 and then for 3
<i>Total</i>	520	

5. Analysis

5.1. Project choice

Due to the heritage association not placing strict requirements concerning the material they wished digitalised, we could select based on interest, the condition of the objects and suitability for digitalisation and their need for preservation. We initially chose a newspaper clippings book containing articles relating to Enåker, compiled by a member of the heritage association. Due to copyright and intellectual property laws, publishing the material publicly would not be feasible due to it being fewer than seventy years since the authors' death (Sveriges Riksdag, 1960).

Additionally, publishing personal information digitally, including life-events from institutions such as newspapers, raises privacy ethical questions concerning a person's right to be forgotten, when initially information was not intended to be shared digitally (Manžuch, 2017). Furthermore, it is likely that the articles are already digitised through their respective newspapers.

We then opted for our second option, the logbook, and deemed it culturally relevant alongside its interest for the parish residents and association especially as it was the only logbook of its kind in the archives. Additionally, the handwritten aspect of the book also played a role in our decision as the text was legible, making the information accessible. The opportunity to digitise it means that it would become accessible for people that struggle to interpret the handwritten style whilst preserving the material for long-term use.

5.2. Image capture and preservation

When choosing the best method for image capture, we initially tested a camera on a Kaiser Fototechnik stand with two adjustable lights and a black background. This proved unsatisfactory as the available lighting was too bright and gave a suboptimal result. We then tested using an A3 flatbed scanner from the university's library, with 600 DPI resolution in TIFF format, as recommended by Cornell University Library (2003). This provided better results with high quality, completely legible text.

Due to the size and format of the logbook, a scan covered roughly one and a half pages only. After numerous scans, we decided that despite the quality provided, the image capturing and editing would be unnecessarily laborious. After contacting numerous archives and libraries to enquire about using a larger scanner we determined the National Archives book scanner to be the best option.

The Bookeye 5, a specialised overhead tool, was an appropriate size to capture both sides of the logbook in one scan. Initially the scans performed a standard mode of 200 DPI resolution, which resulted in uneven images in terms of shadow and brightness. After scanning through the entire book, we became aware of adjustable

settings and we increased the DPI to 400 (highest available) and added “anti-reflection” mode in addition to 24-bit colour. The images became even and of higher quality. It was only possible to save the scans in a multi-page PDF format which was not optimal but was the only solution available and seems to be the standard for multi-page formats (Cornell University Library, 2003).

5.3. Transcription

When it came to deciding how to transcribe the entire textual document, we initially tested Google’s OCR tool after considering occasionally illegible handwriting in the “anmärkningar” section of the book and due to OCR being quicker, if successful. This was especially the case regarding pages recording the pupils’ attendance.

Upon uploading images reflecting both attendance and the objects made, we determined that the accuracy was too low and that the time saved would be negligible due to correcting errors and proofreading (Tanner, 2004). Additionally, OCR did not recognise the attendance characters and due to the layout of the book, including tables and our determination to replicate the structure, we chose to transcribe by hand.

After we transcribed the entire book, we ensured that the information was accurate through proof-reading the transcription four times, once by us both and additionally by two native Swedish speaking board members. We do not have Swedish as our native language and did not want to risk potentially missing aspects related to language. Furthermore, the association members were less familiar with the material and could offer alternative perspectives.

We chose not to transcribe the information regarding the pupils’ attendance as it was repetitive and did not match with our aim that favoured the objects produced. We determined that this would be more interesting for potential visitors to the website, as alongside the pupils’ names, residences and guardians the objects are the most culturally relevant information.

5.4. Text encoding

The information in the logbook is structured in complex tables that have nested columns and cells ranging multiple rows. To tackle this, we set out to test whether encoding the transcription directly in HTML and using the TEI file for metadata purposes only was a better approach. However, we quickly realised that this would amount to more than double the work, and that the formatting would not be as consistent compared to structuring the transcriptions directly in TEI. Additionally, tables in TEI/XML can be indexed (Renear, 2004), which could facilitate the creation of a search feature in an eventual future iteration of the project.

Because we were unfamiliar with TEI beyond coursework, we spent a significant amount of time familiarising ourselves with TEI.

Complex tables such as the ones in the logbook proved hard to code in TEI. At first, we chose to make tables with columns and sub columns, but this did not translate well into HTML, even when using the appropriate table, cell and row templates in XSL (Dubinsky, 2020). Thus, we made the decision to structure the table utilising relevant headers spanning across multiple columns to best mimic the original structure. The original table consisted of rows where the cells were subdivided into additional rows, to tackle this we utilised line breaks.

Our plan was to create a TEI template parallel to the digitisation and transcription of the logbook with the idea to complete it once the text was transcribed. This proved to be unhelpful, as it is difficult to convey the logbook's table structure in a spreadsheet. Ultimately, the tables in TEI had to be edited, and coding in TEI was done parallel to proof-reading the transcription and validating the structure by comparing the images featured on the website.

The TEI file is entirely in Swedish, both to correspond with the original material and to increase accessibility to the target audience, namely the residents of the parish who are predominantly Swedish speaking.

We chose not to encode the visible stains displayed on one of the images due to them not aligning with our project's aims, but we recognise that they could be included in a future project addressing the material's condition and we included information on this in the relevant image's description.

5.5. Metadata

We chose the PREMIS model for digital preservation metadata because it is flexible, exhaustive and compatible with TEI (Dappert, Squire Guenther, & Peyrard, 2016).

The PREMIS model for digital preservation metadata recommends seven preservation goals for successful digital preservation, however no exact metadata fields are specified: 1) availability; 2) identity; 3) understandability; 4) fixity; 5) viability; 6) renderability, and 7) authenticity (Dappert, Squire Guenther, & Peyrard, 2016; Chapter 2).

The model allows metadata to be stored within the resources themselves (Dappert, Squire Guenther, & Peyrard, 2016). We chose to store the metadata within TEI, as the <teiHeader> module has placeholder fields for metadata (The TEI Consortium, Technical Council, 2014).

The principle of availability relates to the reference information, context information, and access rights information (Dappert, Squire Guenther, & Peyrard, 2016; Chapter 3). To address this, we included information on both published and project dates and licence information within the publication statement under the header module. Information about where the physical logbook is stored was included thus addressing the availability principle.

Identity relates to object identification and events that changed the form of the object (Dappert, Squire Guenther, & Peyrard, 2016; Chapter 3). To address this, we included information on how the logbook was scanned and transcribed, as well as information on its contents and title. We also included information on the scope of the project due to its limited length, which also addresses the renderability principle (Dappert, Squire Guenther, & Peyrard, 2016; Chapter 3).

Understandability relates to an intellectual identity's description (Dappert, Squire Guenther, & Peyrard, 2016; Chapter 3). We addressed this through multiple fields in our metadata, including the information on the logbook's contents, and information concerning the type of implement employed to write different parts of the handwritten text.

Authenticity relates to the physical characteristics of the digitised object (Dappert, Squire Guenther, & Peyrard, 2016; Chapter 3). We addressed this by including information on the book's size and page format, an important factor in the book's digital preservation in case the physical copy is damaged or lost. Meanwhile fixity encompasses information regarding the physical characteristics of the book and how it is preserved (Dappert, Squirt Guenther & Peyrard, 2016; chapter 3).

Viability mostly relates to file format and how resilient the metadata file is (Dappert, Squire Guenther, & Peyrard, 2016; Chapters 6 and 17). We address this by storing the metadata in XML format which is an open format that can be opened in any free text editor.

For this project, we chose to use the metadata fields available in TEI instead of specific fields detailed in the PREMIS standard (Dappert, Squire Guenther, & Peyrard, 2016). However, we believe that our metadata is PREMIS compliant, as PREMIS is based on principles, allowing flexibility in how the metadata record is implemented (Dappert, Squire Guenther, & Peyrard, 2016).

5.6. Webpage

The website is simple and easy to navigate in its structure to facilitate access to the digitised logbook. Though digitised material cannot replace the original material (Milekic, 2007), we believe that the website does a good job at replicating the logbook's contents whilst preserving its cultural heritage. While writing the website in English would increase accessibility we chose Swedish to align with the assumed mainly Swedish-speaking audience.

Coding the website was relatively unproblematic, but we had a few issues with the XSL and css codes. The template to transform TEI tables into HTML tables translated the column span attribute, which most browsers ignore, this resulted in us altering the table structure detailed in 3.5. This is a known issue with TEI tables (Dubinsky, 2020) and we could quickly find a solution that worked better.

Styling the website was a trial-and-error process, as our experience with css is limited. We coded images in "galleri" as zoomable, but even with corresponding css code, this does not translate to the website. This could be due to how the images are defined in the HTML and css codes, but due to time constraints we chose not to investigate this issue.

5.7. Long-term preservation

The goal of preserving cultural heritage material is to maintain its existence in an unknown future (Smith, 2004). Preserving the logbook in digital form ensures that the contents are available, even if the original material is lost or degrades but creating for long term preservation insists upon certain considerations (Smith, 2004).

Digital media can degrade (Smith, 2004) and maintaining files on a drive or computer entails risks. Publishing a website on a cloud service online reduces those risks and facilitates long-term preservation, explaining why we published our website on GitHub pages. Accounts can get lost and we have no way to guarantee that our GitHub repository will live at eternum, which is why we will suggest to the heritage association to take over our website and host it on their server. The association has been active since 1943 and will likely maintain their activity in the future whilst also possessing the greatest interest in preserving the logbook. Alternatively, digital archives exist where we could house our digitised material.

Degradation is not the only concern when preserving digital objects (Smith, 2004). To successfully preserve a digital object, the files behind said object need to be readable and file emulation must be possible (Smith, 2004). Metadata schemas ensure that the material is understandable in the future, but if those schemas are not

accessible in the future, they are unfit for purpose (Smith, 2004). To tackle this, all files related to the website, including the TEI file and images, are in open formats that have a higher chance of digital survival. However, one file concerns us regarding long-term preservation, the pdf file with the original scans. While PDF is an open standard, editing PDF files usually requires licensed software. PDF is, however, an ISO standard (The International Organization for Standardization, 2026) and will remain a highly supported format in the future, allowing the accessibility of the images even if editing the original file might be constrained.

5.8. Unexpected events and time constraints

When the project commenced, our group consisted of four members, and we divided the tasks intending to digitalise the logbook in its entirety. One group member discontinued the course early and we redistributed tasks maintaining our original plan but realising that digitising all years might be unfeasible.

Due to geographical restraints, Alexandra would focus on the physical meetings with the association, image capture and editing and transcription whilst Joana would focus on TEI and all coding relating to the webpage. The third group member would assist in image editing, transcription including proofreading and TEI, in addition to the webpage if needed. All members would work on the report.

Due to personal circumstances, our third group member became uncooperative with strained communication. With less than a month remaining, we decided to continue as a pair. The book was already scanned and transcribed in its entirety whilst coding progress was made. This loss created further time constraints, and we chose to limit the project to the years 1900—1902, prioritising quality of digitalisation over volume of work. The goal is to complete the project as first idealised for the association during our free time.

6. Feedback from Enåker's local heritage association

From the onset, the association has provided enthusiastic support for our engagement and allowed us to choose our material. Members of the board facilitated contact with the municipal archives in Morgongåva, Heby and joined the visit to assess possible materials. The feedback that we received was very positive and they appreciate having an element of local cultural heritage digitalised to reach a larger audience. Additionally, they were positive to our suggestion for continuing the project to its completion.

7. Conclusion

While we had to reduce the size of the project, we believe that we successfully digitised the logbook for the chosen time period, and that our website can be used by those interested in digitised cultural heritage materials. Long-term preservation of the website is still a point of concern, and we hope that the heritage association will take over its ownership to ensure our work's long-term survival.

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